

Pildoo Sung

Assistant Professor of Sociology

📍 Seoul, South Korea ✉ pildoosung@hanyang.ac.kr 📞 0000-0002-5730-6241 🎓 Google Scholar

Academic Position

Hanyang University , Assistant Professor, Department of Sociology	Seoul, South Korea 2024 – present
Hong Kong Baptist University , Assistant Professor, Department of Sociology	Hong Kong 2023 – 2024
Duke-NUS Medical School , Research Fellow, Centre for Ageing Research and Education (CARE)	Singapore 2020 – 2023

Education

PhD National University of Singapore , Sociology	Singapore 2020
MA Korea University , Sociology	Seoul, South Korea 2014
BA Korea University , Sociology	Seoul, South Korea 2009

Research Interests

Research: Social Capital, Social Participation, Social Isolation, Loneliness, Social Gerontology, Caregiving, Longitudinal Analysis

Publications

Associating Multimorbidity Patterns with Healthcare Utilization and Unmet Healthcare Needs among Older Koreans Living Alone H. Yun, B. Son, <i>Pildoo Sung</i> 10.1111/ggi.70663 (Geriatrics & Gerontology International)	2026
Lonely by Comparison: Understanding Loneliness Through Network Alter Status, Ego Status, and Regional Status Accepted <i>Pildoo Sung</i> , W. Sung, H. H. S. Kim (Journal of Health Psychology)	2026
Exploring Loneliness in Family Caregiver–Care Recipient Dyads: Implications for Care-giver Burden <i>Pildoo Sung</i> , A. Chan 10.1111/ggi.70499 (Geriatrics & Gerontology International)	2026
Oral Health-Related Quality of Life and Social Engagement: Gender Differences <i>Pildoo Sung</i> , Y. Zhang, M. Kang, S. H. Kang 10.1177/00220345261438375 (Journal of Dental Research)	2026

Who Keeps on Learning? Understanding Heterogeneity in Resource Profiles of Older Learners to Promote Recurrent Engagement in Learning Accepted <i>Pildoo Sung, A. Maulod, A. Chan, R. Malhotra</i> (Journal of Aging and Social Policy)	2026
Stability and Change in Social Network Profiles After Widowhood and Their Implications for Depressive Symptoms Among Older Adults in South Korea <i>Pildoo Sung, J. Lim-Soh</i> 10.1002/psp.70231 (Population, Space and Place)	2026
Getting Lonely and Isolated? Transitions in Social Isolation Profiles Over Time and Factors Associated with Them Among Older Adults <i>Pildoo Sung, A. Chan, A. Visaria, J. M.-L. Lee</i> 10.1016/j.socnet.2025.12.005 (Social Networks)	2025
Stress, Social Isolation Profiles, and Depressive Symptoms Among Older Adults in a Low-Income Community in Singapore <i>Pildoo Sung, V. J. W. Koh, A. Chan</i> 10.1002/gps.70183 (International Journal of Geriatric Psychiatry)	2025
The Mediating Role of Formal Social Engagement in the Relationship Between Oral Health and Depressive Symptoms Among Older Adults in South Korea <i>Pildoo Sung, Y. Zhang, J. Y. Choi</i> 10.1002/gps.70085 (International Journal of Geriatric Psychiatry)	2025
Sharing in Caring: Family Caregiving Task Sharing Patterns for Older Adults in Singapore <i>J. Lim-Soh, Pildoo Sung, H.-L. Quach, R. Malhotra</i> 10.1093/geronb/gbae186 (The Journals of Gerontology, Series B)	2025
Functional Limitations and Depressive Symptoms among Older Adults in Korea: Gender Differences in the Moderating Roles of Relationship Satisfaction with Family, Friends, and Neighbors <i>J. Y. Choi, Pildoo Sung</i> 10.1177/08982643241304884 (Journal of Aging and Health)	2024
A Reciprocal Relationship between Social Engagement and Grip Strength <i>J. Son, Pildoo Sung</i> 10.1159/000540344 (Gerontology)	2024
Stress and Loneliness among Family Caregivers of Older Persons with Cognitive Impairment: The Mediating Role of Social Isolation and the Moderating Role of Personal Mastery <i>Pildoo Sung, J. Lim-Soh, J. M.-L. Lee, A. Chan</i> 10.1177/08982643241262374 (Journal of Aging and Health)	2024
The Relationship among Generalized Trust, Social Networks, and Social Resources across Thirty Countries <i>J. Son, Pildoo Sung</i> 10.1177/02685809241251770 (International Sociology)	2024
Informal Caregiver Social Network Types and Mental Health: The Mediating Role of Psychological Resilience <i>Pildoo Sung, J. Lim-Soh, R. Malhotra</i> 10.1080/08959420.2024.2319535 (Journal of Aging and Social Policy)	2024

- Trajectories of Adherence to a Falls Prevention Exercise Intervention in Singapore: A Mixed Methods Study** 2024
J. M.-L. Lee, *Pildoo Sung*, K. Y. Tan, P. Duncan, R. Sim, K. Koh, A. Chan
[10.1016/j.ahr.2024.100181](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ahr.2024.100181) (Aging and Health Research)
- Feeling Alone Together: Loneliness in Older Adults with Cognitive Impairment and Their Family Caregivers with Low Mastery** 2024
Pildoo Sung, J. Lim-Soh, A. Chan
[10.1159/000536644](https://doi.org/10.1159/000536644) (Dementia and Geriatric Cognitive Disorders)
- Engagement in Physical Activity and Quality of Life Among Informal Caregivers of Older Adults** 2023
S. A'Azman, *Pildoo Sung*, R. Malhotra
[10.1177/08982643231209086](https://doi.org/10.1177/08982643231209086) (Journal of Aging and Health)
- Older Adult Patient Preferences for the Content and Format of Prescription Medication Labels — A Best-worst Scaling and Discrete Choice Experiment Study** 2023
R. Malhotra, S. D. Suppiah, Y. W. Tan, *Pildoo Sung*, S. S. C. Tay, N. C. Tan, G. C.-H. Koh, A. Chan, L. S. T. Chew, S. Ozdemir
[10.1016/j.sapharm.2023.07.009](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.sapharm.2023.07.009) (Research in Social and Administrative Pharmacy)
- Health Profiles among Community Dwelling Older Adults with Cognitive Impairment and Their Implications for Caregiving Experience** 2023
Pildoo Sung, J. Lim-Soh, A. Chan
[10.1159/000530606](https://doi.org/10.1159/000530606) (Dementia and Geriatric Cognitive Disorders)
- Reciprocal Relationship Between Lifelong Learning and Volunteering** 2023
Pildoo Sung, A. Chia, A. Chan, R. Malhotra
[10.1093/geronb/gbad003](https://doi.org/10.1093/geronb/gbad003) (The Journals of Gerontology, Series B)
- Lonely in a Crowd: Social Isolation Profiles and Caregiver Burden Among Family Caregivers of Community-dwelling Older Adults with Cognitive Impairment** 2023
Pildoo Sung, J. M.-L. Lee, A. Chan
[10.1177/08982643221137939](https://doi.org/10.1177/08982643221137939) (Journal of Aging and Health)
- The Reciprocal Relationship Between Social Engagement and Cognitive Function Among Older Adults in South Korea** 2023
J. Son, *Pildoo Sung*
[10.1177/07334648221148953](https://doi.org/10.1177/07334648221148953) (Journal of Applied Gerontology)
- Does a Reciprocal Relationship Exist between Social Engagement and Depression in Later Life?** 2023
J. Son, *Pildoo Sung*
[10.1080/13607863.2021.2024794](https://doi.org/10.1080/13607863.2021.2024794) (Aging & Mental Health)
- Met and Unmet Needs of Older Adults with Cognitive Impairment, and Burden and Benefits of Their Family Caregivers** 2022
Pildoo Sung, N. Hashim, R. Malhotra, A. Chan
[10.1097/WAD.0000000000000529](https://doi.org/10.1097/WAD.0000000000000529) (Alzheimer Disease & Associated Disorders)
- Care Needs Profiles and Their Association with Caregiver Strain among Community-Dwelling Older Adults with Cognitive Impairment** 2022
Pildoo Sung, A. Chan
[10.1159/000525999](https://doi.org/10.1159/000525999) (Dementia and Geriatric Cognitive Disorders)

- The Negative Impact of Adult Children's Marital Dissolution on Older Parents' Mental Health in South Korea** 2022
P.-C. Ko, *Pildoo Sung*
[10.1093/geronb/gbac056](https://doi.org/10.1093/geronb/gbac056) (The Journals of Gerontology, Series B)
- Transitions between social network profiles and their relation with all-cause mortality among older adults** 2022
G. H.-L. Cheng, *Pildoo Sung*, A. Chan, S. Ma, R. Malhotra
[10.1016/j.socscimed.2021.114617](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.socscimed.2021.114617) (Social Science & Medicine)
- Transition in Social Network Types over Time among Older Adults** 2022
Pildoo Sung, R. Malhotra, G. H.-L. Cheng, A. Chan
[10.1159/000521213](https://doi.org/10.1159/000521213) (Gerontology)
- Types of Caregiving Experience and Their Association with Caregiver Depressive Symptoms and Quality of Life** 2022
Pildoo Sung, V. S. Goh, N. D. Azman, A. Visaria, R. Malhotra
[10.1177/08982643211051568](https://doi.org/10.1177/08982643211051568) (Journal of Aging and Health)
- In-Group Trust and Self-Rated Health in East Asia Using Quadri-National Survey Data** 2020
Pildoo Sung, J. Son
[10.1177/0020715220937752](https://doi.org/10.1177/0020715220937752) (International Journal of Comparative Sociology)
- Urban-rural Disparities in Social Network Profiles among Older Koreans at the Early Stage of the Pandemic** 2025
Pildoo Sung
[10.51952/9781529246735.ch007](https://doi.org/10.51952/9781529246735.ch007) (Social Connection in Everyday Space (book chapter))
- The Latent Classes of the Volunteer Satisfaction Index and Donation during the Pandemic in Singapore** 2024
J. Son, *Pildoo Sung*, B. Tay
[10.1007/978-3-031-63440-6_9](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-63440-6_9) (Well-being During the Pandemic: Comparative Perspectives from the Global North and the Global South (book chapter))
- Buffering Function** 2021
Pildoo Sung
[10.1007/978-3-030-22009-9_506](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-22009-9_506) (Encyclopedia of Gerontology and Population Aging (encyclopedia entry))
- Met and Unmet Needs of Community-dwelling Older Singaporeans with Cognitive Impairment** 2022
Pildoo Sung, N. Hashim, A. Chan
[10.25722/y68m-tn8x](https://doi.org/10.25722/y68m-tn8x) (Centre for Ageing Research and Education, Research Brief Series 13 (report))
- Transitions in Health, Employment, Social Engagement and Intergenerational Transfers in Singapore Study (THE SIGNS Study) — II: Cross-Sectional and Longitudinal Analyses of Key Aspects of Successful Ageing** 2020
A. Chan, R. Malhotra, A. Visaria, *Pildoo Sung*, B. J. S. S. Ching, T. Y. Wen
[10.25722/kfgy-nb7](https://doi.org/10.25722/kfgy-nb7) (Centre for Ageing Research and Education (report))

Work in Progress

- Associating Multimorbidity Patterns with Healthcare Utilization and Unmet Healthcare Needs among Older Koreans Living Alone**
Yun, H., Son, B., & Sung, P. — Status: Under review.

Lonely by Comparison: Understanding Loneliness Through Network Alter Status, Ego Status, and Regional Status

Sung, P., Sung, W., & Kim, H. — Status: Under review.

Stability and Transitions in Social Network Types in the Pandemic Outbreak and Their Association with Mid-pandemic Depression among Older Koreans

Sung, P., & Son, J. — Status: Under review.

The Strength of Strong Ties: Resources in Close Relationships and Life Satisfaction Across 30 Countries

Sung, P., & Son, J. — Status: Draft available.

Drifting into Isolation or Growing into the Core? Joint Trajectories of In-Degree and Out-Degree Centrality and Later-Life Cognitive Function among Older Adults

Sung, P., & Youm, Y. — Status: Draft available.

Adherence Trajectories and Determinants of Adherence Transition Patterns from Active Intervention to Self-Maintenance Phases of an Exercise-based Falls Prevention Programme

Koh, V. J. W., Sung, P., Tan, K. Y., Lee, J. M.-L., & Chan, A. — Status: Draft available.

Post-retirement Trajectories of Depressive Symptoms in South Korea: The Positive Role of Returning to Work

Lim-Soh, J., Xiang, C. H., Ang, S., Sung, P., & Malhotra, R. — Status: Draft available.

Conference Presentations

Oral Health-Related Quality of Life and Formal Social Engagement Among Older Adults: How Does Gender Matter?

2025 – 2026

- 2026 — Singapore Conference on Ageing and Health 2026, Singapore
- 2025 — Hong Kong Sociological Association 26th Annual Conference, Hong Kong

Who Keeps on Learning? Understanding Heterogeneity in Resource Profiles of Older Learners to Promote Recurrent Engagement in Learning

2025

- Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Seoul, Korea

Lonely by Comparison: Individual, Network, and Regional Occupational Status and Loneliness across 30 Countries

2025

- 5th ISA Forum of Sociology, Rabat, Morocco

Reciprocal Relationship Between Oral Health and Social Engagement Among Older Adults: A Gendered Story

2025

- 5th ISA Forum of Sociology, Rabat, Morocco

Exploring Loneliness in Family Caregiver-Care Recipient Dyads: Implications for Care-giver Burden

2024 – 2025

- 2025 — Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting, Singapore
- 2024 — Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Seoul, Korea

Connected, yet Vulnerable: Stress, Social Isolation, and Mental Health among Older Adults

2024 – 2025

- 2025 — Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting, Singapore
- 2024 — Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Seoul, Korea

Mechanisms Linking Oral Health and Mental Health in Later Life: The Mediating Role of Social Engagement and Life Satisfaction • International Alliance of Research Universities ALH Scientific Conference, Oxford, UK • Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting, Singapore	2024
Stability and Change in Social Network Profiles after Widowhood and Their Impact on Mental Health among Older Adults • Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Seoul, Korea	2023
Oral Health, Social Engagement, and Depressive Symptoms among Older Adults • Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Seoul, Korea	2023
Understanding Resource Profiles of Older Learners to Promote Recurring Engagement in Learning • Hong Kong Sociological Association 24th Annual Conference, Hong Kong • Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting, Tampa, Florida	2023
Feeling Alone Together: Loneliness among Older Adults with Cognitive Impairment and their Family Caregivers with Low Mastery • Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting, Tampa, Florida • Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Jeonju, Korea	2023
Profiles of Volunteer Motivations During the COVID-19 Pandemic and Their Implications for Volunteer Activities • XX ISA World Congress of Sociology, Melbourne, Australia	2023
Social Capital and Life Satisfaction: A Cross-national Comparison • Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Jeonju, Korea	2023
Stability and Change in Social Isolation Profiles over Time Among Older Adults • 2023 — Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting, Tampa, Florida • 2022 — International Alliance of Research Universities ALH Scientific Conference, Copenhagen, Denmark	2022 – 2023
Change in Social Network Types among Older Koreans before and during the COVID-19 Pandemic • 2023 — XX ISA World Congress of Sociology, Melbourne, Australia • 2023 — Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting, Singapore • 2022 — Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Seoul, Korea • 2022 — Japan Sociological Society Annual Meeting, Osaka, Japan	2022 – 2023
Caregiver Social Network Types and Depressive Symptoms: The Mediating Role of Psychological Resilience • 2023 — Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting, Singapore • 2022 — Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Seoul, Korea	2022 – 2023
Transitions in Social Network Types among Older Singaporeans • International Alliance of Research Universities ALH Scientific Conference, Copenhagen, Denmark	2022
Transitions in Social Support Exchange Profiles over Time among Older Adults • Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting, Indianapolis, Indiana	2022

Profiles of Met and Unmet Needs of Cognitively Impaired Older Singaporeans and Their Association with Caregiver Well-being	2021
• Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Virtual	
Met and Unmet Needs of Cognitively Impaired Older Adults and Burden and Benefits of Their Caregivers	2021
• Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting, Virtual	
Transitions in Adherence Trajectories from Intervention to Maintenance of a Falls Prevention Exercise Program	2021
• Gerontological Society of America Annual Scientific Meeting, Virtual	
Caregiving Experience Types and Caregiver Quality of Life	2020
• Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Virtual	
Trust, Social Participation, and Depression among Older Adults in Low- and Middle-Income Countries	2018
• International Alliance of Research Universities ALH Scientific Conference, Singapore	
Trust and Well-being: A Multi-country Analysis	2018
• XIX International Sociological Association World Congress of Sociology, Toronto, Canada	
Trust and Self-rated Health in East Asia	2018
• International Sociological Association RC 28 Spring Meeting, Seoul, Korea	
Parental Volunteering, Church Attendance, and Young Adults' Volunteering	2018
• International Sociological Association joint conference for RC06 & RC41, Singapore	
Global Pioneer Seeks for Globality: Institutionalization, Crisis, and Restructuring of E-Sports in Korea	2015
• East Asian Conference for Young Sociologists, Seoul, Korea	
Structural Change in the Oil Industry in Korea	2014
• Korean Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Seoul, Korea	
Invited Talks	
Lonely by Comparison: Individual, Network, and Regional Occupational Status and Loneliness across 30 Countries	2025
• Medical sociology colloquium, Korea University	
Social Determinants of Mental Health Among Older Adults in Korea	2025
• Korea University Institute of Aging	
• Korea Inequality Research Network	
Trust and Social Capital	2024
• Global Multicultural Education Center, Sun Moon University	
Reciprocal Relationship Between Oral Health and Social Engagement among Older Adults: A Gendered Story	2024
• Medical sociology colloquium, Ewha Womans University	
Stability and Change in Social Network Profiles after Widowhood and Their Impact on Mental Health among Older Koreans	2024
• Department of Geography, National University of Singapore	

Multi-wave Panel Data Analysis	2023
• Department of Internal Medicine, The Catholic University of Korea	
Composition and Dynamics of Social Networks among Older Singaporeans	2023
• Centre for Ageing Research and Education, Duke-NUS Medical School	
Health Profiles among Community Dwelling Older Adults with Cognitive Impairment and Their Implications for Caregiving Experience	2022
• Singapore General Hospital 24th Annual Scientific Meeting	
Transition in Social Network Types among Older Singaporeans and Implications to Life-space Studies	2022
• Singapore Population Health Symposium	
The Reciprocal Relationship Between Volunteering and Lifelong Learning	2021
• Centre for Ageing Research and Education, Duke-NUS Medical School	
Profiles of Caregiving Experience Types Based on the Benefits and Burden of Caregiving, and Their Association with Caregiver Mental Health and Quality of Life	2021
• Centre for Ageing Research and Education, Duke-NUS Medical School	
Social Networks and Health among Older Adults	2020
• Department of Sociology, Korea University	
Social Capital and Life Satisfaction	2019
• Department of Sociology, National University of Singapore	
Online Interaction and Out-group Trust	2019
• Centre for Family and Population Research, National University of Singapore	
Trust and Happiness among Older Adults in Low- and Middle-income Countries	2019
• Faculty of Arts & Social Science Research Division Health Cluster, National University of Singapore	
Social Capital and Trust	2018
• Department of Sociology, National University of Singapore	

Honors, Grants & Awards

- HYU International Collaboration Grant (PI), Hanyang University (2025–2026)
- Start-up Grant, Hanyang University (2024)
- Travel Award, Department of Geography, National University of Singapore (2024)
- Start-up Grant, Hong Kong Baptist University (2023)
- Travel Award, Japanese Sociological Society (2022)
- Research Scholarship, Department of Sociology, National University of Singapore (2015–2019)
- The Best Article Award, Korea University Graduate Studies (2015)
- Research Scholarship, Korea University (2012–2014)

Teaching Experience

Hanyang University , Instructor	Seoul, South Korea
• Health and Social Behavior [SOC4046]	2025 – 2026
• Social Problems [SOC3032]	
• Medical Sociology Seminar, Graduate [SOC9116]	
• Social Networks and Social Capital, Graduate [SOC9115]	

Hanyang University , Instructor • Sociology and the New Industrial Revolution [SOC1055] • Intermediate Social Statistics, Graduate [SOC9109]	Seoul, South Korea 2024 – 2024
Hong Kong Baptist University , Instructor • Careers and Life Courses [SOCI3027] • Globalization [SOCI4016]	Hong Kong 2023 – 2024
Duke-NUS Medical School , Instructor, Methods Workshop: Latent Class/Transition Analysis Delivered at the Centre for Ageing Research and Education (2021–2023); also invited to the Association of Pacific Rim Universities Population Aging Program and the Department of Sociology, Korea University (2022).	Singapore 2021 – 2023
National University of Singapore , Teaching Assistant • Data Analysis in Social Research [SC3209], 2018 • Sociology of Life Course and Ageing [SC3214], 2017 • Understanding Globalization [GEK1041], 2016 • Making Sense of Society [SC1101], 2015	Singapore 2015 – 2018

Professional Service

BMC Geriatrics , Editorial Board Member	2024 – present
Korean Journal of Sociology , Editorial Board Member	2024 – present
Journal of the Korean Gerontological Society , Editorial Board Member	2023 – 2024
Health and Social Science , Editorial Board Member	2023 – 2024
Hong Kong Baptist University , Grant Reviewer, Seed Grant Funding Scheme	2023 – 2023
19th Seoul International Symposium on Gerontology , Organizing Committee Member	2025 – 2025
Population Association of Singapore Annual Meeting , Organizing Committee Member	2023 – 2023
12th Association of Pacific Rim University Population Ageing Conference , Organizing Committee Member	2022 – 2022

Journal Reviewer

Reviewer for: Aging and Health Research, Australian & New Zealand Journal of Public Health, BMC Geriatrics, BMC Public Health, Dementia and Geriatric Cognitive Disorders, Health & Place, Health Psychology, Health and Social Science, International Journal of Comparative Sociology, Journal of Aging and Health, Journal of Applied Gerontology, Journal of the Korean Gerontological Society, Korea Journal of Population Studies, Korean Journal of Sociology, Scientific Reports, Social Science Research, Sociology of Health & Illness, The Gerontologist, The Journals of Gerontology Series B

Professional Organization Membership

Member of: Gerontological Society of America, Hong Kong Sociological Association, International Alliance of Research Universities Aging Longevity and Health Early Career Researcher Network, International Sociological Association (RC55 Social Indicators), Korean Gerontological Association, Korean Sociological Association, Population Association of Singapore